

Session Objectives

1. Identify and utilize the standard questions asked to female patients regarding their gynecological history from menarche through menopause
2. Identify and utilize the standard questions asked to non-pregnant female patients regarding their obstetrical history
3. Identify and utilize the standard questions asked to pregnant female patients regarding their obstetrical history, current pregnancy including postpartum
4. Describe the basics of a pap smear including indication for and how the screening test is performed

Session Objectives

**NEW YORK INSTITUTE
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College of Osteopathic
Medicine

1. Identify and utilize the standard questions asked to female patients regarding their gynecological history from menarche through menopause

Gynecological History

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Why are we asking questions about the patients' gynecological history?

- Identify any areas of concern

- Inquire about the status of gynecological screening exams

This allows the physician to:

- Discuss sensitive topics

- Answer questions

- Provide patient education and anticipatory guidance



Gynecological History

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What questions should we ask?

Symptoms/Complaints

Menstrual Cycle

Menopause

Breast

Pap Smear

Mammogram

Sexual Activity

Contraception

Family History

Symptoms/Complaints

Common areas to address include:

- Breast, thyroid, vulvovaginal, pelvic, colorectal
- Are you having any problems with your breasts? (Review Breast section for more details)
- To ask about thyroid disorder inquire about:
 - Any recent weight gain/loss?
 - Any new onset fatigue?
 - Any hair loss or changes in hair?
 - Any cold/heat intolerance?
 - Any dry skin?
 - Any constipation?
 - Any heart palpitations?
 - Any mass in your neck?
 - Any mood swings/irritability?
- Are you having any... ?
 - discharge? (Nipples or Vaginal)
 - If so....
 - What color?
 - What consistency?
 - Any odor?
 - lumps, masses, or lesions? (Breasts or Vulvovaginal)
 - tenderness, pain, burning, dryness, or tingling? (Breasts, Pelvic, Vaginal, Rectal)
 - abnormal vaginal bleeding for you?
 - any bleeding from the rectum?

Gynecological History

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Family History

Menarche/Menstruation

- Menarche
 - How old were you when you started menstruating?
- Menstruation
 - When was the first day of your last menstrual period? (FDLMP)
 - How often do you have your menses?
 - How long does it last?
 - How heavy is your menses or flow? (# of pad or tampons used daily or hourly)
 - Any bleeding between your menses?
 - Any pain with your menses?
 - Any bleeding with sex or after sex?

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Menopause

If no longer menstruating:

When did you stop menstruating?

How old were you when you stopped menstruating?

Are you having any of the following symptoms:

Hot Flashes

Night Sweats/Sleep Disturbances/Insomnia

Vaginal Dryness/Irritation/Dyspareunia

Urinary Frequency/Urgency/Nocturnal Enuresis

Depression/Mood Swings

Difficulty Concentrating

Change in libido

Are you now having any times of vaginal bleeding/spotting?

Assessing for postmenopausal bleeding

Gynecological History

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Breast

Have you noticed any...?

- Problems?
- Lump or mass...? If so...
 - Where?
 - Any tenderness or pain? If so...
 - Where?
- Skin changes?
- Nipple problems...?
 - Discharge...? If so...
 - Which breast or both?
 - With compression or spontaneous?
 - Color?

Do you perform a breast exam (or breast awareness)?

When during your cycle?

How often?

How do you perform?

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Sexual Activity

Make sure you are in an appropriate setting (i.e. any family members or other individuals in the room?), non-judgmental and preface questioning (i.e. I ask the following questions to all my patients)

Have you ever been sexually active?

Are you currently sexually active?

- Include oral, vaginal, and/or anal sex (may include asking about vagina-to-vagina, penis-to-penis, and any use of sexual toys)

What is your sexual orientation?

How many partners do you currently have?

How many lifetime partners have you had?

Do you prefer sex with men, women including transgender men or transgender women, or any combination?

Do you use protection?

Any history of STIs?

Any concerns for any STIs today including HIV?

Any problems with intercourse?

Any problems with arousal or getting aroused?

Any problems with orgasm or achieving orgasm?

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Contraception

Are you currently trying to prevent pregnancy?

If so..

- What method are you using? (oral contraceptive pill, injection, vaginal ring, intrauterine device, implant, abstinence, barrier, permanent sterilization)
- Are you using it as prescribed?

If not...

- Do you understand you could become pregnant? (except if they or their partner have had permanent sterilization)
- Are you taking a prenatal vitamin?

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2. Identify and utilize the standard questions asked to non pregnant female patients regarding their obstetrical history

Obstetrical History

Currently Non Pregnant

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Why are we asking questions about the patients' obstetrical history?

To obtain general health information and identify any previous surgical interventions

Some medical conditions may start in pregnancy and continue throughout their lifespan

This allows the physician to:

Have a better overall picture of a patients health and surgical history



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3. Identify and utilize the standard questions asked to pregnant female patients regarding their obstetrical history, current pregnancy including postpartum

Obstetrical History Currently Pregnant

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Why are we asking questions about the patients' obstetrical history?

In obstetrics, past history can be a good indicator of the future

Identify any areas of concern that may require special testing, added surveillance or consultations

This allows the physician to:

- Discuss sensitive topics

- Answer questions

- Provide education and guidance



Obstetrical History

Currently Pregnant

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What questions should we ask?

Menstrual and pregnancy confirmation

Pregnancy history

Symptoms/Complaints

Concerns/Attitude

Symptoms/Complaints* not an exhaustive list

Have you had any of the following symptoms:

Vaginal bleeding?

Nausea and vomiting?

Breast fullness and tenderness?

Fatigue and urinary frequency?

Vaginal discharge?

Obstetrical History

Postpartum Visit

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What questions should we ask?

Postpartum

Postpartum

How are you doing?

Are you having any fevers, abdominal pain or vaginal discharge?

Have you started your menses yet?

Are you breast feeding/bottle feeding or both?

Are you having any problems with feeding?

Are you having any problems with your breasts?

(Looking for issues like mastitis)

Are you having any signs/symptoms of depression/anxiety?

(Edinburgh Postnatal Depression Scale given to patient)

Do you have good support around you?

Have you been sexually active since delivery?

Are you interested in contraception/family planning?

Make sure they follow up with their provider for continued GYN care and health screenings (i.e. pap smears, etc.). May also provide a return to work note, if needed.

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4. Describe the basics of a pap smear including indication for and how test is performed

Source: Course Syllabus

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